

Machu Picchu today

Since Bingham first arrival and the excavations that followed, the site of the Inca city has been completely cleared of undergrowth, revealing buildings made of polished dry stone walls that have survived for hundreds of years. This stonework has been cleaned and patched, and some outlying structures have been completely rebuilt.

1 Sun stone

This stone was used as a sundial, with four points marking north, south, east, and west.

2 Houses

Inca homes were built with stone walls and thatched roofs.

Mountain top

The city sits on a mountain ridge, with steep cliffs dropping away all around it. The tallest mountain peak above the city, Huayna Picchu, was once topped by Inca temples.

